

Word family: **do / does / did / done / doing / doable / doer / redo / undo**

Base word: do

Third-person singular: does

Past tense: did

Past participle: done

-ing form: doing

Related forms: doable, doer, redo, undo

Useful extensions/constructions: do something, do work/homework, do your best, do someone a favour, do good/harm/damage, do business, do a subject/course, do your hair, do the dishes, How are you doing?, that will do, do = auxiliary in questions/negatives, emphatic do, substitution do, so do I, do the trick, make do, to-do list, dos and don'ts, well done

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / auxiliary verb (助動詞) / occasional noun-related and lexicalized extensions (相關名詞及固定用法)

Your passage contains several forms and functions of **do**:

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever **done** was giving a formal presentation in English...”

> “I **did** it because my supervisor asked me to represent the team...”

> “I **did not** need to be perfect.”

> “I **did make** a couple of small mistakes, but I kept going instead of freezing.”

These examples are especially useful because they demonstrate **three different functions** of the same word family.

Meaning in this passage

Passage use 1: **have done / did it = perform or carry out an action**

In:

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever **done**...”

and:

> “I **did it** because my supervisor asked me...”

do is a normal lexical verb.

It means:

****perform, carry out, undertake, or complete an action/activity.****

****繁體中文： ** **進行、完成或實際做某件事情 / 活動****

中文翻譯

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever ****done**** was giving a formal presentation in English...”

「我曾經****做過 / 完成過****其中一件最具挑戰性的事情，就是用英文作正式簡報。」

> “I ****did it**** because my supervisor asked me to represent the team...”

「我之所以****去做這件事****，是因為我的上司叫我代表團隊.....」

So:

****do something = 實際進行、完成或執行某件事情****

Passage use 2: **did not = auxiliary used to form a negative**

In:

> “I ****did not**** need to be perfect.”

****did**** does not independently mean 「做」.

It is an ****auxiliary verb**** used to make the past-tense negative:

> ****did not + base verb****

= 過去並沒有 / 不需要.....

So:

****did not need = 當時不需要****

Here, ****did**** mainly carries grammatical past tense and negation support rather than an independent lexical meaning.

Passage use 3: **did make = emphatic do**

In:

> “I **did** make a couple of small mistakes...”

did is again an auxiliary, but this time it adds **emphasis**.

The sentence means approximately:

> “I really did make a couple of mistakes.”

The speaker is acknowledging that the mistakes genuinely happened, often in contrast with another point:

> **I did make mistakes, but I kept going.**

繁體中文： **的確 / 確實有.....**

Natural translation:

「我中間**的確**犯了**幾個小錯**，但我沒有停下來，而是繼續講下去。」

So:

do/did + verb for emphasis = 的確 / 確實有做某事

1. **do + thing/task/activity (事情 / 任務 / 活動) — 做；進行；執行**

This is the broad basic lexical meaning in your passage.

Meaning: To perform, carry out, or engage in an action, task, or activity.

Practice 1 — Original

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever **done** was giving a formal presentation in English.”

「我曾經**做過**其中一件最具挑戰性的事情，就是用英文作正式簡報。」

Practice 2

> “I have several things to **do** before the meeting.”

「開會前我有幾件事情要**處理 / 完成**。」

Practice 3

> “She **did** everything she could to prepare.”

「她為了做好準備，把自己能**做**的事情都做了。」

do something = 執行、進行或完成某個行動、任務或活動

This is an extremely broad meaning, so the exact Chinese translation changes naturally with context.

2. **do + work/homework/task/job** (工作 / 功課 / 任務) — 做 ; 完成

A very common collocational branch of the basic action sense.

Practice 4

> “I usually **do my homework** after dinner.”

「我通常晚飯後**做功課**。」

Practice 5

> “We need to **do some work** before the presentation.”

「我們在簡報前需要先**做一些工作 / 完成一些準備工作**。」

do work/homework/a task = 進行或完成需要處理的工作、功課或任務

Common:

* **do your homework** = 做功課

* **do some work** = 做工作

* **do a task** = 執行任務

* **do a job** = 完成某項工作

3. **do household/routine activities** (家務 / 日常工作) — 做 ; 處理

English frequently uses **do** with routine activities.

Practice 6

> “I need to **do the dishes** after dinner.”

「晚飯後我要**洗碗 / 處理碗碟**。」

Practice 7

> “She was **doing the laundry** when I called.”

「我打電話給她時，她正在**洗衣服**。」

Common patterns:

* **do the dishes** = 洗碗

* **do the laundry** = 洗衣服

* **do the cleaning** = 打掃

* **do the shopping** = 購物

* **do the ironing** = 熨衣服

These do not require separate lexical meanings of **do**; they are useful collocations under the broad “perform an activity” sense.

4. **do + subject/course/exam** (科目 / 課程 / 考試) — 修讀 ; 學習 ; 應考

Especially common in British and international English.

Meaning: To study, take, or participate in an academic subject, course, qualification, or examination.

Practice 8

> “She **did** economics at university.”

「她在大學**修讀經濟學**。」

Practice 9

> “I’m **doing** an English course this year.”

「我今年正在**修讀英文課程**。」

do a subject/course = 修讀 / 學習某個科目或課程

Depending on context:

> **do an exam**

can mean **take/sit an exam**:

「參加 / 應考某項考試」

This usage is particularly common in British English and some other varieties.

5. **do + exercise/activity (運動 / 活動) — 從事 ; 進行**

Practice 10

> “I **do yoga** three times a week.”

「我每星期**做三次瑜伽 / 練三次瑜伽**。」

Practice 11

> “He **does** a lot of exercise.”

「他平日**做很多運動**。」

do + activity = 從事或進行某項活動

Common:

* do exercise

* do yoga

* do research

* do training

* do an experiment

Again, these are largely collocational branches rather than entirely separate semantic senses.

6. **do research/an experiment/a study (研究 / 實驗) — 進行 ; 從事**

Very common in academic and professional English.

Practice 12

> “The researchers **did** several experiments.”

「研究人員**進行了**幾項實驗。」

Practice 13

> “We need to **do more research** before reaching a conclusion.”

「我們在下結論前需要**進行更多研究**。」

do research/an experiment = 實際進行研究、調查或實驗工作

Natural Chinese normally uses:

* 進行研究

* 進行實驗

* 進行調查

rather than literally 「做」 in formal contexts.

7. **do + something for someone (為某人做某事) — 幫某人完成 / 處理**

Practice 14

> “Could you **do something for me**?”

「你可以**幫我做一件事**嗎？」

Practice 15

> “She **did all the preparation for us**.”

「她替我們**完成了所有準備工作**。」

do something for someone = 為某人執行、處理或完成某件事情

A very common extension is:

> **do someone a favour**

= 幫某人一個忙

8. **do someone a favour (幫助) — 幫某人一個忙**

A very useful fixed construction.

Practice 16

> “Could you **do me a favour** and check my slides?”

「你可以**幫我一個忙**，替我檢查一下投影片嗎？」

Practice 17

> “She **did him a favour** by covering his shift.”

「她替他頂班，**幫了他一個忙**。」

do someone a favour = 為某人做一件對他有幫助的事情

Notice the double-object pattern:

> **do + person + a favour**

9. **do good/harm/damage** (造成某種效果) — 帶來好處 / 傷害 / 損害

Here **do** means approximately **cause or produce an effect**.

Practice 18

> “A short break may **do you good**.”

「短暫休息一下可能會**對你有好處**。」

Practice 19

> “The storm **did serious damage** to the building.”

「暴風雨**對建築物造成嚴重損毀**。」

Common:

* **do good** = 帶來好處

* **do harm** = 造成傷害

* **do damage** = 造成損害

* **do someone good** = 對某人有益

****do + effect/result noun = 造成或帶來某種影響、好處或損害****

10. ****do business (商業活動) — 做生意；進行商業往來****

A major business expression.

Practice 20

> “The company ****does business**** in more than twenty countries.”

「這家公司在二十多個國家****經營業務 / 做生意****。」

Practice 21

> “We have ****done business with**** them for years.”

「我們跟他們已經****有多年的商業往來****。」

****do business = 從事商業活動；與其他人 / 公司進行交易或合作****

Common:

> ****do business with + company/person****

= 與.....有商業往來

11. ****do your best (盡最大努力) — 盡力而為****

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 22

> “I was nervous, but I ****did my best****.”

「我雖然很緊張，但我已經****盡了最大努力****。」

Practice 23

> “Just ****do your best**** and don’t worry about being perfect.”

「只要****盡力而為****，不用擔心自己是否完美。」

****do your best = 盡自己最大的努力去完成某件事****

This fits your presentation passage extremely well.

12. ****do well/badly (表現如何) — 表現得好 / 差****

Here ****do**** refers to a person's performance or success in a situation.

Practice 24

> “She ****did very well**** in the presentation.”

「她在簡報中****表現得非常好****。」

Practice 25

> “How did you ****do**** in the interview?”

「你在面試中****表現得怎樣****？」

****do well/badly = 在某項活動、考試、工作或比賽中的表現好 / 差****

This is not naturally translated as 「做得」 in every context.

For example:

> “How did you do in the exam?”

= 「你考試****考得怎樣****？」

13. ****How are you doing? / be doing well (狀況) — 過得怎樣；情況如何****

A very common conversational meaning.

Practice 26

> “How are you ****doing****?”

「你最近****過得怎樣 / 情況如何****？」

Practice 27

> “She is **doing much better** now.”

「她現在的**情況好多了** / 恢復得好多了**。**」

be doing + well/badly/better = 某人的整體狀況、健康、進展或生活情況如何

The precise interpretation depends on context:

- * health;
- * emotional state;
- * progress;
- * business performance;
- * general life situation.

14. **business/company/product is doing well/badly** (業務 / 事物表現) — 經營 / 表現良好或不佳

The same performance concept extends to businesses and systems.

Practice 28

> “The company is **doing well** despite the weak economy.”

「儘管經濟疲弱，這家公司仍然**經營得不錯** / 表現良好**。**」

Practice 29

> “The new product is **doing better than expected**.”

「新產品的**市場表現比預期好**。」

something is doing well/badly = 某項業務、產品、計劃等的整體表現或進展好 / 差

This belongs to the same broader performance sense as #12–13.

15. **do = be enough / be suitable** (足夠 ; 適用) — 可以了 ; 夠用了 ; 合適

This is a genuinely distinct lexical meaning.

Practice 30

> “We don’t need a large room. This one will **do**.”

「我們不需要大房間，這間**就可以了 / 已經夠用**。」

Practice 31

> “Will two copies be enough?”

> “Yes, that should **do**.”

「兩份夠嗎？」

「夠了，**這樣應該可以**。」

****will do / that will do = 某樣東西雖未必最好，但已足夠符合需要或用途****

This does ****not**** mean “perform an action.”

16. ****That'll do / that will do = stop; enough (夠了) — 可以了；到此為止****

The same “sufficient” meaning can become an instruction to stop.

Practice 32

> “****That'll do****, everyone. Let's move to the next topic.”

「****可以了 / 到這裡就好****，各位。我們進入下一個話題。」

Practice 33

> “****That will do!**** Stop arguing.”

「****夠了！****不要再爭了。」

****that will do = 已經足夠，不需要再繼續****

Tone can range from neutral to quite firm depending on context.

17. ****do + food/hair/makeup (處理 / 整理 / 準備) — 弄；整理；準備****

Here ****do**** means to ****prepare, arrange, clean, style, or otherwise attend to something****.

Practice 34

> “She was **doing her hair** before the event.”

「活動前她正在**整理 / 弄頭髮**。」

Practice 35

> “I’ll **do the food** while you prepare the room.”

「你準備房間，我來**準備食物**。」

Common:

* **do your hair** = 弄 / 整理頭髮

* **do your makeup** = 化妝

* **do your nails** = 整理 / 美甲

* **do the food** = 準備食物

do something = 對某物進行所需的整理、準備或處理

18. **do a place/room/building** (裝修 / 整理) — 裝修；布置

Especially common in British English, often as **do up**, but bare **do** can also occur in certain contexts.

Practice 36

> “They had the whole house **done** last year.”

「他們去年把整間屋都**重新裝修 / 整理過**。」

Practice 37

> “We’re having the kitchen **done** next month.”

「我們下個月會把廚房**重新裝修**。」

Here:

have something done = 找人替自己完成某項服務 / 工作

The exact meaning comes from context:

* hair done;

* kitchen done;
* repairs done;
* nails done.

19. **do + distance/speed/amount (完成某個數量 / 速度) — 行駛；達到；完成**

A useful measurement-related meaning.

Practice 38

> “The car can **do** 200 kilometres an hour.”

「這輛車的最高速度可以**達到每小時二百公里**。」

Practice 39

> “We **did** nearly twenty kilometres that day.”

「我們那天一共**走了接近二十公里**。」

do + speed/distance/amount = 達到、行駛或完成某個數量 / 距離 / 速度

Context determines the exact Chinese verb.

20. **do + place/attraction (遊覽) — 遊覽；參觀**

Informal, especially in travel contexts.

Practice 40

> “We **did** Paris in three days.”

「我們用了三天時間**遊覽巴黎主要景點**。」

Practice 41

> “We can **do** the museum in the morning and the old town in the afternoon.”

「我們早上可以**參觀博物館**，下午再遊覽舊城區。」

do a place/attraction = 在旅程中參觀、遊覽或體驗某個地方

This is informal and often suggests covering the principal sights or activities.

21. **do + prison sentence/time (服刑) — 服.....年刑期**

An established informal meaning.

Practice 42

> “He **did** three years in prison.”

「他在監獄裡**服了三年刑**。」

Practice 43

> “She had already **done** six months of her sentence.”

「她當時已經**服了六個月刑期**。」

****do + time/years = 在監獄服一段指定刑期****

This is informal but common in media, films, and conversation.

22. **do + impression/voice/person (模仿) — 模仿 ; 扮演**

****Meaning:**** To imitate the voice, behaviour, style, or manner of another person.

Practice 44

> “He can **do** a very good impression of his manager.”

「他可以把經理**模仿得非常像**。」

Practice 45

> “Can you **do** that actor’s voice?”

「你可以**模仿那位演員的聲音**嗎？」

****do an impression / do someone = 模仿某人的聲音、動作或風格****

This is usually informal.

23. **do = auxiliary for questions (疑問句助動詞) — 用來構成一般現在 / 過去時疑問句**

This is grammatical multifunctionality rather than an ordinary lexical meaning.

Practice 46

> “**Do** you feel nervous before presentations?”

「你在做簡報前會感到緊張嗎？」

Practice 47

> “**Did** you practise before the event?”

「你在活動前有練習嗎？」

Pattern:

> **Do/Does + subject + base verb?**

> **Did + subject + base verb?**

Here **do** itself is normally **not translated as 「做」**.

It supports tense and question formation.

24. **do = auxiliary for negatives (否定句助動詞) — 用來構成否定**

This occurs directly in your passage.

Practice 48 — Original

> “I **did not need** to be perfect.”

「我當時**不需要**做到完美。」

Practice 49

> “I **don’t feel** as nervous now.”

「我現在**沒有那麼緊張**。」

Practice 50

> “She **doesn’t use** a script anymore.”

「她現在**已經不用講稿**了。」

Pattern:

> **do/does not + base verb**

> **did not + base verb**

do-support in negatives = 以 do/does/did 承擔時態並配合 not 構成否定句

Again, **do** is grammatical here rather than carrying its normal lexical meaning.

25. **emphatic do + base verb** (加強語氣) — 的確；確實；真的

This occurs directly in your passage.

Practice 51 — Original

> “I **did make** a couple of small mistakes, but I kept going.”

「我的確**犯了幾個小錯**，但我仍然繼續講下去。」

Practice 52

> “I **do understand** why you are worried.”

「我**的確明白**你為甚麼擔心。」

Practice 53

> “She **does work** extremely hard.”

「她**確實**工作得非常努力。」

do/does/did + base verb = 強調後面的動作或陳述確實成立

This often appears when:

* correcting someone;

* contradicting an assumption;

- * acknowledging something;
- * expressing strong sincerity.

Compare:

> “I made mistakes.”

neutral statement

versus:

> “I **did** make mistakes.”

= **我的確有犯錯**

Your sentence uses this very naturally before **but**:

> **I did make mistakes, but I kept going.**

It acknowledges the negative point while emphasizing the more important contrast.

26. **do** = substitute for an earlier verb phrase (代替前述動作) — 用 do 避免重複整個動詞片語

Another major grammatical function.

Practice 54

> “She practises every evening, and I **do** too.”

「她每天晚上都練習，我**也是**。」

Here:

do = practise every evening

Practice 55

> “He speaks more confidently than he **did** last year.”

「他現在說話比去年**更有自信**。」

Here:

****did = spoke last year****

****substitution do = 用 do/does/did 代替前面已經出現的完整動作，避免重複****

27. ****so do I / neither do I (表示相同情況) — 我也是 / 我也不.....****

A major construction involving auxiliary ****do****.

Practice 56

> “I feel nervous before presentations.”

> **“**So do I.**”**

「我做簡報前會緊張。」

「****我也是。****」

Practice 57

> “I don’t enjoy speaking in front of huge audiences.”

> **“**Neither do I.**”**

「我不喜歡在很多人面前演講。」

「****我也不喜歡。****」

Pattern:

> ****So + do/does/did + subject****

= 某個肯定情況也適用於另一個人

> ****Neither/Nor + do/does/did + subject****

= 某個否定情況也適用於另一個人

The auxiliary changes depending on the original verb and tense.

28. ****do + verb in commands/polite persuasion (加強命令 / 邀請) — 務必；真的請.....****

Another emphatic auxiliary use.

Practice 58

> “**Do come in.**”

「**請進來吧 / 真的請進。 **」

Practice 59

> “**Do let me know** if you need help.”

「如果你需要幫忙，**務必告訴我**。」

****do + imperative verb = 加強邀請、請求或命令的語氣****

Depending on tone, it can sound:

- * warm and encouraging;
- * polite but insistent;
- * emphatic.

29. ****What do you do? (職業) — 你做甚麼工作？****

A very common special conversational use.

Practice 60

> “What ****do you do****?”

「你****做甚麼工作 / 從事甚麼職業****？」

Practice 61

> “What does your brother ****do****?”

「你哥哥 / 弟弟****從事甚麼工作****？」

Here the second ****do**** broadly means:

****work as / have as an occupation****

while the first ****do**** is merely the question auxiliary.

So:

> **What do you do?**

contains **two different functions of do in the same sentence**:

1. first **do** = question auxiliary;
2. second **do** = work / engage in an occupation.

30. **do the trick** = achieve the desired result (奏效) — 奏效 ; 達到所需效果

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 62

> “A few deep breaths usually **do the trick** before a presentation.”

「做幾次深呼吸通常就能**奏效 / 幫助我平靜下來**。」

Practice 63

> “If the screen freezes, restarting the computer may **do the trick**.”

「如果畫面停住，重新啟動電腦可能就能**解決問題 / 奏效**。」

do the trick = 成功產生所需要的效果或解決問題

This does not literally refer to performing a trick.

31. **make do** = manage with what is available (將就 ; 勉強應付) — 將就使用 ; 因陋就簡

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 64

> “We didn’t have a microphone, so we had to **make do** without one.”

「我們沒有咪高峰，所以只好**將就應付**。」

Practice 65

> “The hotel was full, so we **made do** with a smaller room.”

「酒店滿了，所以我們只好**將就住一間較小的房間**。」

****make do = 在條件或資源不理想的情況下，用現有的東西勉強應付****

This is a fixed expression and should not be analysed simply as ordinary ****make + do****.

32. ****done = finished/completed (完成的) — 做完了；完成了****

****Done**** can function adjectivally as well as being the past participle of ****do****.

Practice 66

> “I’m ****done**** with the presentation slides.”

「我的簡報投影片已經****做完了****。」

Practice 67

> “Are you ****done****?”

「你****完成了嗎 / 弄好了嗎****？」

****done = 某項工作或活動已經完成，不需要再繼續****

In informal English:

> ****I’m done.****

can mean:

- * 我做完了；
- * 我不做了；
- * 我受夠了；

Context determines the interpretation.

33. ****done = cooked sufficiently (食物煮熟的) — 熟了；煮好了****

A genuinely distinct adjective-like meaning.

Practice 68

> “The chicken isn’t **done** yet.”

「雞肉還沒有**煮熟**。」

Practice 69

> “How do you like your steak **done**?”

「你的牛扒想要**煎到甚麼熟度**？」

done = 食物已經烹調到足夠 / 指定的熟度

This is especially common with meat.

34. **well done** (稱讚) — 做得好；幹得漂亮

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 70

> “You handled the presentation extremely well. **Well done!**”

「你這次簡報處理得非常好。**做得好！**」

Practice 71

> “**Well done** on completing the project.”

「成功完成項目，**做得很好 / 值得稱讚**。」

well done = 用來稱讚某人成功完成某件事情或表現良好

Do not confuse this with:

> **well-done steak**

= 全熟牛扒

Same words, very different application.

35. **doable** = possible to do successfully (可做到的) — 可行的；做得到的

A very useful modern derivative.

Practice 72

> “The presentation will be difficult, but it is **doable**.”

「這次簡報雖然困難，但仍然是**可以做到 / 可行的**。」

Practice 73

> “Finishing everything today is **doable** if we work together.”

「如果我們一起做，今天完成所有事情是**可行的**。」

doable = 雖然可能需要努力，但實際上能夠完成或實現的

Register:

doable is common and relatively informal/neutral.

36. **doer** = person who takes action (實幹的人) — 實幹者；會付諸行動的人

A useful person noun.

Practice 74

> “She is a **doer**, not just a talker.”

「她是一個**會真正付諸行動的實幹者**，不只是說說而已。」

Practice 75

> “The company needs practical **doers** who can turn ideas into results.”

「公司需要能把構思化為成果的**實幹型人才**。」

doer = 不只是討論或計劃，而是真正採取行動並完成事情的人

The word is commonest in contrasts such as:

> **thinkers and doers**

= 思考者與實幹者

37. **redo = do again (重做) — 重新做**

A transparent but useful family member.

Practice 76

> “I had to **redo** one of my slides.”

「我不得不把其中一張投影片**重新做一次**。」

Practice 77

> “The work was incorrect, so we **redid** it.”

「工作有錯，所以我們把它**重新做了一遍**。」

****redo = 因修改、改善或錯誤而把某件事情重新做一次****

Forms:

* redo

* redid

* redone

* redoing

38. **undo = reverse what was done (撤銷 / 恢復) — 取消；還原；解開**

Although historically/morphologically related to **do**, **undo** is now its own very useful lexical item.

Practice 78

> “Press this button to **undo** your last change.”

「按這個按鈕可以**撤銷 / 還原上一項修改**。」

Practice 79

> “He **undid** the top button of his shirt.”

「他**解開了**恤衫最上面的鈕扣。」

****undo = 把之前完成的動作反過來、取消其效果，或解除某種已形成的狀態****

This produces several contextual Chinese translations:

* undo a change = 撤銷修改

* undo a button = 解開鈕扣

* undo damage = 扭轉 / 消除損害

It should be labelled as a ****family extension****, not simply another meaning of bare ****do****.

39. ****to-do / to-do list (待辦事項) — 待辦事項；工作清單****

A highly useful lexicalized compound.

Practice 80

> “Preparing the slides is at the top of my ****to-do list****.”

「準備投影片是我****待辦事項清單****上的第一項。」

Practice 81

> “I still have several ****to-dos**** before the event.”

「活動前我還有幾項****待辦事項****。」

****to-do = 尚未完成、需要處理的事情****

Most common:

> ****to-do list****

= 待辦事項清單

40. ****dos and don'ts = things you should and should not do (應做與不應做的事情) — 注意事項；宜忌****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 82

> “The trainer explained the **dos and don’ts** of giving a presentation.”

「導師講解了做簡報時的**應做與不應做事項 / 注意事項**。」

Practice 83

> “Learn the basic **dos and don’ts** before your first interview.”

「第一次面試前，要先了解基本的**注意事項和宜忌**。」

dos and don’ts = 某種情況下應該做及應避免做的事情

Spelling note:

dos and don’ts is the common modern spelling.

Important distinction: **do vs make**

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

Both can translate loosely as 「做」 in Chinese, but English collocations differ.

do

usually focuses on:

- * performing an activity;
- * carrying out work;
- * completing a task.

Examples:

> **do homework**

「做功課」

> **do some work**

「做一些工作」

> **do research**

「進行研究」

make

often focuses on:

- * creating or producing something;
- * causing a result;
- * forming something.

Examples:

> **make a cake**

「做 / 製作蛋糕」

> **make a decision**

「作出決定」

> **make a mistake**

「犯錯」

This last one appears in your passage:

> “I did make a couple of small mistakes.”

Here:

* **did** = emphatic auxiliary

* **make** = lexical verb

Not:

>  do a mistake

Normally:

>  **make a mistake**

So the sentence contains two different verbs performing completely different jobs.

Important distinction: **do something vs make something**

do something

often means:

> perform an action

> “I need to **do something**.”

「我需要**做點事情 / 採取行動**。」

make something

often means:

> create or produce it

> “I need to **make something**.”

「我需要**製作 / 弄出某樣東西**。」

Compare:

> “What are you **doing**?”

= 你正在做甚麼活動？

> “What are you **making**?”

= 你正在製作甚麼東西？

Important distinction: **do well vs be well**

do well

usually refers to:

* performance;

* progress;

* success.

> “She **did well** in the presentation.”

「她在簡報中**表現很好**。」

be well

often refers to:

* health;

* general physical condition.

> “She hasn’t **been well** recently.”

「她最近**身體不太好**。」

However:

> “She is **doing well**.”

can also refer broadly to recovery or general condition.

Context matters.

Important distinction: **do** = lexical verb vs auxiliary **do**

This distinction is crucial.

Lexical **do**

has an actual semantic meaning:

> “I **did the work**.”

= 我**完成了工作**。

Auxiliary **do**

mainly performs a grammatical function:

> “**Did** you finish?”

= 你**完成了嗎**？

> “I **didn’t** finish.”

= 我**沒有完成**。

> “I **did** finish!”

= 我的確完成了！

The auxiliary itself does not simply mean 「做」.

Important distinction: **ordinary do vs emphatic do**

Compare:

> “I made a few mistakes.”

neutral fact

versus:

> “I **did** make a few mistakes.”

stronger acknowledgment:

我的確有犯幾個錯。

Emphatic **do** is particularly useful when the sentence later changes direction:

> “I **did** make mistakes, **but** I kept going.”

The speaker concedes one fact while emphasizing a contrasting positive point.

That is exactly what happens in your passage.

Important distinction: **do it vs do so**

Both can refer back to an action, but they behave differently.

do it

often refers to carrying out a specific action:

> “I was afraid to give the presentation, but I **did it**.”

「我害怕做簡報，但最後還是**做到了** / 真的去做了。」

do so

is more formal and substitutes for a previously mentioned action:

> “Employees who wish to apply may **do so** online.”

「希望申請的員工可以**在網上辦理 / 這樣做**。」

do so is especially common in formal writing.

Important distinction: done vs finished

They overlap heavily.

finished

explicitly means completed.

> “The report is **finished**.”

「報告完成了。」

done

often means completed in everyday English.

> “The report is **done**.”

「報告做好了。」

But **done** has additional uses:

* **The chicken is done.** = 雞肉熟了。

* **I'm done.** = 我做完了 / 我不再繼續了。

* **Well done!** = 做得好！

So **done** has a wider conversational range.

Important distinction: doable vs easy

These are not the same.

easy

= requires little difficulty or effort

doable

= possible to complete successfully

Something can be:

> **difficult but doable**

= **雖然困難，但仍然做得到**

Your presentation is a good example:

It was not **easy**, but careful preparation made it **doable**.

Family-extension sweep

The **do** family is unusual because much of its richness comes from:

1. a very broad lexical verb;
2. auxiliary grammar;
3. highly productive collocations and fixed expressions.

Useful items include:

- * **do something** = 做 / 進行某事
- * **do work/homework/a task** = 做工作 / 功課 / 任務
- * **do the dishes/laundry/cleaning** = 做家務
- * **do a subject/course** = 修讀科目 / 課程
- * **do exercise/yoga** = 從事運動
- * **do research/an experiment** = 進行研究 / 實驗
- * **do someone a favour** = 幫某人一個忙
- * **do good/harm/damage** = 帶來好處 / 造成傷害或損害
- * **do business** = 做生意 / 進行商業往來
- * **do your best** = 盡力
- * **do well/badly** = 表現好 / 差
- * **How are you doing?** = 你過得怎樣 / 情況如何
- * **that will do** = 這樣就夠 / 可以
- * **do your hair/makeup** = 整理頭髮 / 化妝
- * **do + distance/speed** = 完成某距離 / 達到某速度
- * **do a place** = 遊覽某地
- * **do time** = 服刑
- * **do an impression** = 模仿

* **auxiliary do in questions** = 構成疑問句
 * **auxiliary do in negatives** = 構成否定句
 * **emphatic do** = 的確 / 確實
 * **substitution do** = 代替前面已提及的動作
 * **so do I / neither do I** = 我也是 / 我也不
 * **do come / do tell me** = 加強邀請、要求或命令
 * **What do you do?** = 你從事甚麼工作？
 * **do the trick** = 奏效
 * **make do** = 將就應付
 * **done** = 完成的；煮熟的
 * **well done** = 做得好
 * **doable** = 可行的 / 做得到的
 * **doer** = 實幹者
 * **redo** = 重做
 * **undo** = 撤銷 / 還原 / 解開
 * **to-do list** = 待辦事項清單
 * **dos and don'ts** = 應做與不應做事項 / 宜忌

I would **not** split every collocation above into an independent lexical meaning.

The core semantic groups are better understood as:

- > **perform/carry out**
- > **cause/produce an effect**
- > **performance/state**
- > **be sufficient**
- > **special lexical uses such as imitate, travel, serve time**
- > **auxiliary grammatical functions**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
do something	實際進行、執行或完成某個行動、任務或活動
do work/homework/a task	完成需要處理的工作、功課或任務
do routine household activities	進行洗衣、洗碗、清潔等日常家務活動
do a subject/course	修讀、學習或參與某個科目、課程或考試
do exercise/activity	從事或進行某項運動或活動
do research/an experiment	實際進行研究、調查或實驗工作

do something for someone	為某人執行、處理或完成某件事情	
do someone a favour	為某人做一件有幫助的事情；幫忙	
do good/harm/damage	造成或帶來某種好處、傷害或損害	
do business	從事商業活動或與另一方進行商業往來	
do your best	投入自己所能做到的最大努力	
do well/badly — performance	在工作、考試、活動等方面表現好 / 差	
be doing well/badly — condition	某人、公司或事情的整體狀況、進展或表現好 / 差	
will do — sufficient	某物雖未必最好，但已足夠符合需要或用途	
that will do — stop	已經足夠，不需要再繼續；可以了 / 夠了	
do hair/makeup/etc.	對某物進行所需的整理、準備或處理	
do + distance/speed	完成某段距離、數量，或達到某個速度	
do a place	在旅程中遊覽、參觀或體驗某個地方	
do time	在監獄服指定時間的刑期	
do an impression	模仿某人的聲音、動作、風格或行為	
auxiliary do — question	用 do/does/did 承擔時態並構成一般疑問句	
auxiliary do — negative	用 do/does/did 配合 not 構成否定句	
emphatic do	強調某個動作或陳述確實成立；的確 / 確實	
substitution do	代替前面已提及的完整動作，以避免重複	
so do I / neither do I	表示前面的肯定 / 否定情況同樣適用於另一人	
do + imperative	加強邀請、請求或命令的語氣	
What do you do? — occupation	詢問某人的工作或職業	
do the trick	成功產生所需要的效果；奏效	
make do	在資源或條件不足時利用現有東西勉強應付	
done — completed	某項工作或行動已完成，不需要再繼續	
done — cooked	食物已烹調至足夠或指定的熟度	
well done	用來稱讚某人成功完成事情或表現良好	
doable	雖然可能需要努力，但實際上可以完成或實現	
doer	會真正採取行動並把事情完成的實幹者	
redo	因修改、改善或出錯而重新做一次	
undo	把先前動作反過來、撤銷其效果或解除已形成的狀態	
to-do / to-do list	尚未完成、需要處理的事項 / 待辦事項清單	
dos and don'ts	某種情況下應該做及應避免做的事情 / 注意事項	

For your original passage

Your passage actually demonstrates ****three important functions of the do family****.

1. Lexical ****do = perform/carry out****

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever ****done****...”

Here:

****done = 親身進行或完成過的事情****

So:

> ****one of the most challenging things I have ever done****

= ****「我曾經親身做過 / 完成過的事情之中，最具挑戰性的其中一件」****

And:

> **“I **did it** because my supervisor asked me to represent the team...”**

Here:

****did it = 實際接受並完成了做英文簡報這件事****

Natural meaning:

****「我之所以真的接受並做這件事，是因為上司叫我代表團隊。」****

2. Auxiliary **did not = past negative**

> **“I **did not need** to be perfect.”**

Here:

****did = 過去時否定句所需的助動詞，本身並不是「做」****

The meaningful unit is:

> ****did not need****

= ****「當時並不需要」****

So:

> **“I did not need to be perfect.”**

= ****「我不需要做到完美。」****

3. Emphatic **did = 的確 / 確實**

> “I **did make** a couple of small mistakes, but I kept going instead of freezing.”

Here:

did = 用來特別強調「犯錯這件事確實有發生」

Therefore:

> **I did make a couple of small mistakes**

= 「我的確 / 確實犯了幾個小錯。」

The full rhetorical structure is:

> **I did make mistakes, but I kept going.**

= 「我承認自己的確犯了錯，但更重要的是，我沒有因此停下來。」

That distinction is especially valuable for learners because **did** appears twice in your passage with completely different jobs:

> **I did it.**

Here **did** is the main lexical verb:

did = 做了 / 完成了

but:

> **I did make mistakes.**

Here **did** is an auxiliary:

did = 的確 / 確實

and:

> **I did not need to be perfect.**

Here **did** is again an auxiliary:

did not = 用來構成過去否定

So the most important mapping for your passage is:

do = 做 / 進行 / 完成某件事情

****did not + verb = 過去時否定結構****

****did + verb = 強調該動作的確發生；的確 / 確實****

This makes ****do**** one of the strongest polyfunctionality targets in the entire passage: the same tiny everyday word operates both as a highly flexible lexical verb and as one of the central grammatical auxiliaries of English.